

Leonard's knees or wrists could derail—or even end—his entire career. “Wasting” money on a new car with all the latest safety features will reduce the odds of a catastrophic injury that prematurely cuts his playing career short.

That 20-year-old car? It does not have:

- Lane-departure warning
- Lane-keeping assist
- Collision avoidance systems
- Electronic stability control
- Adaptive cruise control
- Blind-spot warning
- Seatbelt pretensioners
- Forward-collision warning
- Crumple zones
- Automatic emergency braking
- Bluetooth.

A question for the rest of us who can neither dunk nor hit the open man cutting to the hoop: Don't you want the latest, greatest safety equipment protecting you and your family? That 20-year-old car has 20-year-old actuators for its 20-year-old airbags, which have 20-year-old sealed gas canisters that are supposed to inflate instantly. Would you, in Los Angeles traffic, bet a \$103 million contract on them?

The key that the spending nags all seem to fail to understand is that budgets are about living within your means, not living like a pauper, whether you have to or not.



Merely saying “no” is not financial advice; it is a form of blind risk